

UNIT 5 · Governance, Public Administration & Sustainability

5.1 Rāmāyaṇa on governance (Rāma-Rājya) **IMPORTANT**

- Vālmīki's epic is also a treatise on leadership and ethical administration. **Rāma-Rājya** = ideal governance: moral authority, citizen welfare (**lokakalyāṇa**), participatory administration. Aligned with transparency, accountability, equity, service. **Servant leadership**: citizens before self.
- Principles**: (i) **citizen-centric administration**; (ii) **advisory councils / consultative governance**: Rāma consulted ministers like Vasiṣṭha (SEE 9a); expert advice → legitimacy and effectiveness; (iii) **ethical law enforcement**: fair punishment/reward (nyāya); (iv) **crisis management** in exile: limited resources, allies, preparation (disaster preparedness, coordination); (v) **sustainability and welfare**: long-term prosperity, ecological balance.
- Case**: after return to Ayodhyā: audits of administration/resources, welfare for all castes and classes, transparent justice, counselling by ministers and citizens → peace, prosperity.

Rāmāyaṇa principle	Modern lesson
Dharma & Nyāya	Ethical policy, legal frameworks
Servant leadership	Officials put citizens before ambition
Team management & delegation	Bureaucratic structure, empowerment
Crisis management	Disaster/contingency planning
Visionary planning	Sustainable development
Communication & diplomacy	Negotiation, stakeholder engagement
Empathy & social justice	Inclusive policies

Key attributes (CIE-3): justice, compassion, dharma, truthfulness, welfare. **Rāja-dharma** = ruler's moral duty to govern justly and protect people. **Lokasaṅgraha** = social welfare / holding the world together (MCQ B). Hindu governance: king's happiness lies in **welfare of subjects**; the king as **servant of the state**.

[BOOK p.377 Rāmāyaṇa attributes ↗](#)

[BOOK p.398 Epics & administration ↗](#)

5.2 Arthaśāstra (Kauṭilya / Cāṇakya, 4th c. BCE) **IMPORTANT**

- First comprehensive manual of public administration: statecraft, economics, law, taxation, military, foreign policy. Blends **dharma** (ethics) with **artha** (pragmatism).
- Eight governance principles**: sovereignty & rule of law · welfare orientation (lokakalyāṇa) · systematic bureaucracy (amātya, treasurers, tax collectors) · strategic/pragmatic leadership ·

financial administration · intelligence & surveillance (spies) · law & justice · ethics & morality.

- **Principles of effective governance:** **Śāḍguṇya** (sixfold policy): **sandhi** (peace), **vigraha** (war), **āśana** (neutrality), **yāna** (march), **saṁśraya** (seek protection / alliance), **dvaiddhībhāva** (dual policy); fourfold responsibility of king (protect, secure wealth, justice, dharma); planning and strategy; ethics + pragmatism.
- **Saptāṅga theory of the state:** **Svāmin** (king), **Amātya** (minister), **Janapada** (territory & people), **Durga** (fort), **Kośa** (treasury), **Daṇḍa** (law/force), **Mitra** (ally). (CIE-3: "Dharma is not an element".)

Element	Meaning	Modern equivalent
Janapāda	"Land of people": territory + people; basic unit for resources, tax, law. Mahājanapadas (Magadha, Kosala, Vatsa...)	State/district administration
Durga	Fort / fortified capital: defence and admin centre. (Symbolic: Durgā over Mahiṣāsura = order over chaos)	Defence, strategic hubs
Kośa	Treasury: revenue, wealth; "treasury is more important than the army" (Kauṭilya); funds everything	Finance dept., budget
Daṇḍa	"Stick": authority, law enforcement, punishment; balances power and justice	Police, judiciary
Mitra	"Friend": alliances, diplomacy (śāḍguṇya)	Foreign policy

Interrelation: Janapada defines the territory → Durga protects it and the Kośa → Kośa funds administration, army, welfare → Daṇḍa maintains order and secures resources → Mitra safeguards the realm and trade. (CIE-3 4b)

IMPORTANT **State sources of income per Arthaśāstra** (SEE Feb 2026 10b; textbook p.388–389)

- **Seven heads:** city, country, mines, irrigation works, forests, cattle-herds, trade routes.
- **Kośa sources:** **Mūlya** (price of state goods), **Bhāga** (share of produce, 1/6th), **Vyājī** (tax on sales), **Parigha** (protective duty), **Kṛpta** (fixed levy at river-banks/ports), **Rūpika** (surcharge on manufactures), **Atyaya** (penalties/fines).
- Land tax 1/6 of agricultural produce; water-usage tax 1/5–1/3; customs (śulka: import/export), excise, toll, pasture leases, fines; mines and state enterprises; labour (viṣṭi).

[BOOK p.379 Arthaśāstra ↗](#)

[BOOK p.381 Kauṭilyan state ↗](#)

[BOOK p.385 Amātya & Janapada ↗](#)

[BOOK p.386 Durga ↗](#)

[BOOK p.387 Kośa ↗](#)

[BOOK p.390 Daṇḍa ↗](#)

[BOOK p.392 Mitra ↗](#)

[BOOK p.396 Relevance ↗](#)

5.3 IKS and the UN SDGs **IMPORTANT**

- **17 SDGs** adopted by the UN in 2015, target 2030. Shared foundation with IKS: sustainability, equity, intergenerational well-being; **Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam** ↔ "leave no one behind". IKS holistic worldview = **Pūrṇatva**.

IKS principle	Essence	SDG
Dharma	Righteous duty, social order	16 Peace, Justice, Institutions
Artha	Sustainable prosperity	8 Decent work & growth
Kāma	Responsible enjoyment	3 Health & well-being
Mokṣa	Inner peace	4 Quality education
Pañca-mahābhūta	Balance with nature	13, 14, 15 Climate, water life, land life
Sarvodaya	Welfare of all	1, 2, 10
Ahiṃsā	Non-violence	16
Swadeshi	Local self-reliance	9, 11, 12

- **Examples:** SDG1: Gram Swaraj. SDG2: Vṛkṣāyurveda, Panchagavya, **Sikkim 100% organic**. SDG3: Ayurveda/Yoga; **International Yoga Day 21 June** (SEE 9b: Ayurveda ↔ SDG 3). SDG4: Gurukula; NEP 2020. SDG5: Gārgī, Maitreyī, Lopāmudrā. SDG6: stepwells, tanks, **Rajasthan johads**. SDG 7/9/11/12: passive cooling in Hawa Mahal/temples. SDG 13–15: sacred groves (Devrai/Kavu). SDG 16/17: Sabhā and Samiti; Mitra.
- **Sustainable governance** = meeting present needs without harming the future (intergenerational equity). Dharma → justice, equality, sustainability.

5.4 Safeguarding traditional knowledge **IMPORTANT**

- **Threats:** **biopiracy**, cultural erosion (languages/oral tradition), lack of documentation, inadequate IPR recognition for community knowledge, global-market exploitation (MNCs).
- **Methods:** (1) digitalisation/documentation (proves "prior art"), (2) legal frameworks/IPR, (3) education integration (NEP), (4) community empowerment.

Mechanism	Role
TKDL (Traditional Knowledge Digital Library)	Codified, searchable database of traditional medicinal knowledge accessible to global patent offices → stops biopiracy / false patents (MQP: to protect Indian TK). Expanding to Yoga, manuscripts, food.
Biological Diversity Act 2002; National Biodiversity Authority	Conservation, benefit sharing; regulates foreign access.
GI Act 1999	Protects origin-specific products (Darjeeling tea, Kanchipuram silk, Mysore sandalwood).
AYUSH, Ministry of Culture, IKS Division (AICTE/MoE), National Mission for Manuscripts, CBBRs	Codification, education, validation, preservation.

IMPORTANT Case studies (SEE 10a: role of TKDL)

- **Turmeric:** US Patent 5,401,504 (1995, Univ. of Mississippi: wound healing). CSIR requested re-examination with Sanskrit/English evidence of prior use → **patent revoked 1997**.
- **Neem:** European Patent 0436257 B1 (1994, W.R. Grace + US Dept of Agriculture: fungicide). Opposed by Indian farmers/activists (RFSTE, Greenpeace) at EPO → **revoked 2000**: lacked novelty and inventive step.
- Lesson: documentation + legal tools can defend TK; TKDL makes proof instantly available to examiners.

Why safeguard now (globalisation): protects community rights and ownership, prevents unauthorised patents, ensures benefit sharing, preserves cultural identity, supports sustainable development.